powerfully influenced India in the past a n d present, were represented and the standard was often that of high scholarship. A m o n g t h e classical languages were Sanskrit and Pali, Arabic a n d Persian; t h e modern languages were Hindi, Urdu, Bengali, Gujarati, Marathi, Telugu, Sindhi a n d Oriya. I h a d all this wealth to draw upon and the only limitation was my own capacity to profit by it. T h o u g h I am grateful to all my companions, I should like to mention especially Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, whose vast erudition invariably delighted me b u t sometimes also rather overwhelmed me, Govind Ballabh Pant, Narendra D e v a and M. Asaf Ali.

It is a year and a quarter since I finished writing this book and some parts of it are already somewhat out of date, and much has h a p p e n e d since I wrote it. I have felt tempted to add and

revise, but I have resisted the temptation. Indeed I could not have done otherwise for life outside prison is of a different texture and there is no leisure for thought or writing. It has been difficult enough for me to read again what I have written. I